Fish Chowder

Ingredients (2–3 servings)

- 2–3 strips bacon, chopped
- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 cup onion, finely chopped
- ½ cup celery, finely chopped
- 1 tbsp flour
- 1¼ cups water
- ¾ tsp Better Than Bouillon vegetable base
- 1 bay leaf
- ¼–½ tsp dried thyme
- 1½ cups potatoes, peeled and diced small
- 0.6 lb haddock, cut in bite-size pieces
- ¾ cup half-and-half
- Black pepper, to taste

Day 1 – Build the Base

- Cook bacon until crisp; remove pieces and leave the fat in the pot.
- Add butter, then onion and celery; cook 10–12 min until lightly browned.
- Sprinkle in flour; stir and cook 1 minute.
- Add water, bouillon, bay leaf, and thyme.
- Add potatoes; simmer 12–15 min until just tender.
- Simmer uncovered 3–5 min to concentrate the base.
- Cool and refrigerate overnight.

Day 2 – Finish

- Reheat gently, 5–10 min.
- Add haddock; simmer 3–4 min.
- Add half-and-half; heat gently. Do not boil.
- Return bacon; remove bay leaf.
- Taste; add pepper and salt only if needed.

Notes

- Bouillon plus bacon may provide enough salt already.
- Mash a few potatoes into the broth if you want it thicker.
- Optional at the end: a tiny splash of lemon juice or a pinch of paprika.